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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Any AI that requires the theft of intellectual property in order to succeed is completely and utterly unethical. This is not a matter of American superiority in AI, it's a matter of American businessmen wanting to further maximize their profits by replacing skilled American workers with automated replacements. The only people that are uplifted by this is the already wealthy, and provides no benefit for the rest of the country. It, in fact, will only harm them and thus this cannot be allowed to pass.

If an AI system requires training to succeed, it should be on material that has naturally entered the public domain or has been approved to be used by the creators of the material - preferably with some manner of reimbursement to the latter for their assistance. An opt-in approach rather than an opt-out, and should 100% be held to by the law to only use this material rather than giving private companies carte blanche to steal intellectual property - American or otherwise. This would allow the American populace and foreign allies to assist in the improvement of AI development and be properly rewarded for their efforts rather than having their work stolen from them.

In addition, the environmental and energy issues caused by such training need to also be monitored and addressed. Any development should and must include attempts to limit the amount of energy used and the harm it causes to the environment in line with any other preexisting laws and agreements - and perhaps should require additional rules and oversight specific to mitigate its damages. Circumventing these will similarly cause more harm than good to the United States.

If a system cannot function without theft of intellectual property and unnecessary amounts of harm to our country's resources and environment, then that is its own failing and thus should fail. It should not be propped up and granted special privilege to perpetuate its crimes and damage in order to succeed. It imposes and hinders the freedoms and rights of the American populace - past, present, and future. Because while there are already many ways letting this pass will cause immediate harm, there's potential for this ruling to set a precedent that will further impinge upon and reduce the freedoms and the rights of US citizens in the future.

The only correct way to move forward with this - if it should be allowed to do so at all - is with appropriate oversight and laws in place in order to protect the creative liberties and intellectual property of the American populace and its foreign allies, as well as the health and safety of the nation's resources and environment if not the world as whole. Not further elevate only the wealthy and further reinforce the idea that laws and rules do not apply to them, as that only further weakens and harms our nation as a whole.